

FLL Rookie Team Charter

Growing, Learning, and Innovating Together • 2026-2027

Welcome to our Rookie Year!

As 4th graders, this is the kids' first big step into team-based engineering. Our goal isn't to take home a gold medal, but to spark a love for science, teach resilience, and build lasting friendships. We are also excited to explore the new 2026 AI Robotics platform together—meaning we are all learning and growing at the same time!

I. How We Support Our Kids (Parent Roles)

Robotics & Engineering (Tech Dads)

- Guide the kids in learning the new robot platform safely.
- Encourage a "try, fail, and try again" mindset.
- Help kids understand coding logic without typing the code for them.

Innovation & Operations (Project Moms)

- Guide the kids' research for their real-world Innovation Project.
- Help practice presentation skills with kindness.
- Keep the team fed (snacks!), informed, and organized.

II. Our Season Journey & Calendar Notes

FLL is a team sport where every practice builds on the last. To help everyone plan, here is our full season at a glance!

Phase	What the Kids Will Do	Family Calendar Notes
Weeks 1-3 <i>Foundation</i>	Learn the basics, build a simple robot, and brainstorm project ideas.	Labor Day (Sept): Let us know if you are traveling so we can share a quick recap!
Weeks 4-8 <i>Exploration</i>	Test robot attachments and interview experts for the project.	Halloween (Oct): Practice might be shortened so kids can enjoy the holiday.
Weeks 9-12 <i>Celebration</i>	Put it all together, run full robot matches, practice presentations, and celebrate!	Nov Tournaments (Veterans / Thanksgiving): We'd love everyone's presence to celebrate our hard work!

III. Our Team Agreements

For the Parents: Communication & Teamwork

- **Consistent Growth:** The kids work in pairs/groups. When someone is missing, it changes the dynamic. If your child cannot make a session, simply text the group **in advance** so coaches can adjust the day's fun plan.
- **Embracing the Mess:** There will be noisy moments and broken robots. We agree to step back, take a breath, and let the kids figure it out together.

For the Kids: Our Team Spirit

What is "Gracious Professionalism®"?

*It is the heart of FIRST LEGO League! It means we learn and compete like crazy, but we treat everyone with respect and kindness in the process. It means helping a teammate who is stuck, cheering for other teams, and remembering that **how** we work together is far more important than winning.*

A great team is built on great attitudes. Here is how we make our team amazing:

- **1. We Share the Fun and the Work:** The robot and computers belong to the whole team. A great attitude means stepping back so a teammate can try, or offering to help when someone is struggling. When everyone gets a turn to build and code, our team grows stronger!
- **2. We Listen to Understand:** Every great invention starts with a crazy idea. When a teammate or coach is speaking, we give them our full attention. A positive attitude means saying *"Tell me more about that idea"* instead of *"That won't work."*
- **3. We Respect Our Space and Teammates:** We use kind words, walking feet, and gentle hands. A great teammate lifts others up! If we disagree, we talk about the *idea*, not the *person*. We also treat our expensive robotic parts with care.
- **4. We Celebrate Mistakes (The "Oops" Moment!):** In engineering, nothing works perfectly the first time. A winning attitude means when the robot crashes, we don't get mad, blame others, or give up. Instead, we cheer for the mistake, ask *"What did we learn?"*, and excitedly try a brand new way.

TEAM REGISTRATION & COMMITMENT FORM

 **ACTION REQUIRED:** Please fill out this page, sign it with your child, and send a clear photo back to the team coaches. We need this information to officially register our team with FIRST®!

A. Student Information

Student's FULL Legal Name:

Preferred Nickname:

Date of Birth (MM/DD/YYYY):

B. Parent / Guardian Contact

Parent 1 Name:

Cell Phone:

Parent 1 Email Address:

Parent 2 Name (Optional):

Cell Phone:

Parent 2 Email Address:

"We have read the Team Charter together. I promise to try my best, support my teammates, and have fun learning. My parents promise to encourage the team, communicate schedules, and let the kids do the work!"

TEAMMATE (STUDENT) SIGNATURE

PARENT / GUARDIAN SIGNATURE

DATE

DATE